AI Will Scale Good Leadership. And Bad Leadership.

The CHRO's Method for Redesigning Work Before AI Scales What's Broken

> *The technology was never the variable. The leader was.*

By Liz Corey | Publishing Fall 2026 | 14 chapters, 14 instruments, one method in five parts

Your company rolled out AI. Adoption is up. And nothing about the work has changed.

If any of this sounds familiar

- Software is making employment decisions somewhere in the company, and nobody can name its owner or say what it is allowed to decide
- You are paying for AI and cannot point to a single process that actually changed
- A screening agent is matching candidates to a job description nobody validated, while candidates run their own agents to apply to everything
- Your managers are using AI for reviews and hard conversations, and nobody set a standard for how

Only 13 percent of organizations have redesigned work around AI. Nearly half of them report meaningful enterprise value from it. Among companies that merely handed out tools, 13 percent do; among companies that automated existing workflows, 24 percent (McKinsey, 2026). The redesign is the value. The tools never were.

AI is an amplifier. It does not fix weak leadership, contradictory knowledge, or ownerless decisions. It scales them, at machine speed. The manager with clear standards gets clearer. The manager with none gets faster confusion.

AI enablement is the answer, and it is not adoption, training, or a tool rollout. It is redesigning work, task by task, so humans and AI produce better outcomes together, under named ownership, on knowledge the organization has made true. Some research firms use the word for the weakest tier of adoption. The job postings do not. This book is about the top tier, whatever you call it.

Leadership is infrastructure: the system underneath the business that turns strategy into action and decisions into behavior. AI is about to expose whether you have any. That is not a technology problem. It is the one you were hired to solve, and this is the operating manual, written by someone who has sat in your chair through every technology wave since the fax machine.

The method, in five parts

Part I
Decode
See the work before you touch the technology.
Work at the task level. Five plain terms. Test your knowledge. Every agent under a job description.

Part II
Redesign
Decide what humans and AI should each do.
The seven-step redesign. The Human / Assist / Automate / Agent matrix. Decision rights. Knowing versus doing.

Part III
Scale
Grow the system without growing what is broken.
What you are about to multiply. The mixed human-agent team. One engine: GROWTH.

Part IV
Embed
Turn new ways of working into the way work gets done.
The experience that survives AI. Culture still set at the top. Why ambiguity has beneficiaries.

Part V
Execute
Put the operating model to work.
Four seats at the table. A ninety-day proof of method. Redesign the work before the amplifier does it for you.

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By the end, a leader can

- Inventory work task by task and set every AI destination by the cost of being wrong, not by what the technology can do
- Deploy an agent the way you would deploy a person: job description, performance standards and KPIs, a named manager. It just does not talk back
- Hold a vendor's agent to your job description, because the document is the spec for a build and the acceptance test for a purchase
- Put one name on every rule that moves money or touches people. Ownership is singular. When two people own a task, nobody does
- Answer for the pattern, not just the case. A screening agent that quietly favors one group does not fail. It performs. Somebody owns that
- Replace the accidental curriculum. Entry-level work was how judgment got built; automate it and you defer a cost, with interest
- Run mixed human and AI teams on one execution engine, GROWTH, and pay people for redesigned work, not for touching the software
- Keep measuring the experience, resolve the ambiguity somebody benefits from, and tell the truth early

Fourteen instruments, one per chapter

Work Taxonomy + AI Opportunity Assessment | **Five Terms + Assignment Structure** | **Knowledge Readiness Test**

Agent Job Description | **Seven-Step Redesign Runsheet** | **Human / Assist / Automate / Agent Matrix**

Decision Rights Matrix | **Capability Gap Assessment** | **Pre-Scale Audit** | **Mixed-Team Operating Rhythm**

GROWTH Conversation Guide + AI Harness Map | **AI-Era Listening Set** | **No-Surprises Protocol**

30/60/90 Enablement Roadmap

Every chapter closes with The CHRO's Move: one action you can take this week with the authority you already hold. Every instrument has a fillable version free to readers. They are the same documents used with clients.

> **In the author's words.** "Do not give an agent a prompt and call it a job. Give it its marching orders."
>
> "That is not an AI failure. That is a job design failure, automated."

What makes it different

- Written by a practitioner who ran the work, not a research firm describing it. The evidence is method and operator experience
- The stories come from shared services, payroll rules, a national recruiting redesign that survived a merger, and applicant tracking systems, because the lessons were true before AI and will be true after
- Agents are treated as what they are: workers with delegated authority. Every one gets a job description built like a performance profile, a named owner, and a review date

Who it is for

CHROs and senior HR leaders in mid-to-large and private-equity-backed companies, and the CEOs and operating partners they work beside. It is written for the HR leader who has the hard conversations, not the one who waits for the policy.

How OnTheGrow delivers the method

The book gives you the documents. The engagement gives you the agents: the intake agent that inventories the work, the analysis engine that classifies it, the taxonomy model that turns hours into headcount and the reason, and GROWTH installed as the operating protocol for your managers and your agents.

The operating manual is ready. The question is whether you will redesign the work before the amplifier does it for you. Start the conversation: liz@onthegrowleadership.com

About the author. Liz Corey is the founder and CEO of OnTheGrow Leadership. She has served as CHRO and Chief People Officer for private-equity-backed companies in software, manufacturing, and quality management, leading organizations through mergers, transformations, and every wave of workplace technology. Creator of the GROWTH Execution Model. Forbes Human Resources Council contributor. onthegrow.ai

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